Ray Payment Strategy · Razorpay routes the payment, Ray routes the deal

Track 2, Recover and Grow with AI · Aayushi, PGP 2027

1 PROBLEM

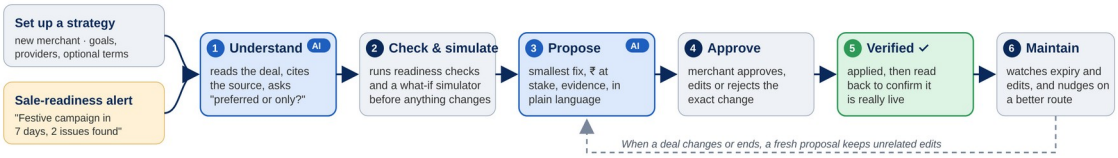
For a merchant with more than one payment gateway, the gateway each payment uses decides how much money they keep. Today nothing checks that choice against the deals they have signed. Take Voltkart, an electronics seller. Meridian Bank funds a no-cost EMI offer, but only when the payment goes through Voltkart's Northstar account. Indus PG cuts its card fee from ₹200 to ₹185, but only if it gets 15% of card payments. Its payments manager, typical of mid-size merchants with several gateways, types these contracts into Optimizer rules by hand. If one rule is wrong, the payment still succeeds, so nobody notices that **the bank subsidy was lost**, **the fee was higher**, or **last month's sale rule is still running**.

RESEARCH BEHIND THIS	WHAT IT SHOWED	WHY NOW
I read more than 70 sources, from Razorpay docs to bank offer terms and merchant forums. **I drew on conversations with 4–5 merchant teams** from my pricing work, a practitioner and a Razorpay test account. Offers are mapped into rules by hand, and misrouted payments still succeed unnoticed.	**Merchants write routing rules** by hand, with no link to the contract. **No tool I found** turns a deal into tested rules and keeps checking them. This input shaped START and kept automated reconciliation out of the MVP.	**Control has moved into the gateway.** Major gateways stopped supporting third-party orchestrators in 2024 and 2025. **The stakes keep rising.** A 0.4% fee on UPI payments above ₹2,000, deferred until after Diwali, will make UPI routing costly too.

2 SOLUTION

Payment Strategy is a new capability inside Ray, Razorpay's agentic dashboard, that turns a merchant's deals into routing they can trust. It does two jobs. It makes sure **every deal is honoured**, and wherever the merchant is free to choose, it **picks the gateway that earns more** after fees and success rate. Ray works on configuration, before each campaign and on a regular schedule, and Optimizer still routes every payment. My working prototype uses a scripted agent and a simulated Optimizer.

MVP PROTECT	LATER EXTENSIONS
Before each campaign and on a schedule, Ray checks that the live routing rules honour every deal, and fixes any gap with the merchant's approval.	**START** gives new merchants an editable setup from similar merchants. **GROW** shows which banks shoppers use and drafts a partnership brief.



WHAT THE AI DOES, STEP BY STEP, IN A FESTIVE EMI CAMPAIGN

AI step	The merchant gives	The agent does
1 Reads the deal	Uploads Meridian Bank's offer sheet	Lists each term and its source (Meridian credit cards, 6 or 9 month EMI, ₹20,000+, 1 to 6 Nov, Northstar only)
2 Spots a contradiction	Two clauses disagree on Northstar	**Asks "Is Northstar required, or just preferred?"** and never guesses
3 Understands plain English	Types "most to Northstar, some to Indus"	**Asks "how much is most?"**, flags that with 4% of cards reserved for the campaign, 90/10 leaves Indus PG under its 15% floor, forecasts 84/16 on the rest at 15.36% by payment count, and tracks the real monthly share
4 Simulates before go-live	Tests current rules, a split or a sale window	*"1 in 10 festive EMI payments would go to Indus PG and lose the subsidy, ₹12,400 at risk."* Estimate from 1,240 payments × 10% × ₹100 subsidy
5 Proposes the fix	Reviews the proposal	*"Campaign EMI goes to Northstar, other cards move to 84/16, nothing else changes."*
6 Picks the better route	Ordinary payments, either gateway	*"You keep ₹15.96 more per ₹10,000 payment on Northstar."* From ₹2,000 margin, 97.8% at ₹180 vs 98% at Indus's standard ₹200. At the deal fee of ₹185, the gap narrows to ₹1.26
7 Nudges proactively	Nothing, as the agent keeps watching	*"Northstar's card success rate improved. Review your routing?"* It never switches by itself.
Control and permissions	The merchant can edit, approve, reject, pause or roll back. The agent only drafts, only an authorised approver can apply, and access is set by role.	
Accuracy, trust and failure	Terms link to their source, and unclear ones trigger a question. Stale approvals and read-back mismatches are blocked.	
AI and the maths	Fixed templates can't read differently worded deals, so AI reads contracts, spots conflicting clauses and turns plain English into structured conditions. A deterministic engine checks every constraint and does every ₹ calculation.	
Optimizer today vs new	Existing in Optimizer docs: issuer, card type, amount and % split. New: an EMI flag as a custom identifier, and Ray publishing and retiring the rule on sale dates, as the public docs show no date condition.	
Verified vs reconciled	Verified means the rule is live. Reconciled means settlement shows the subsidy arrived, using merchant settlement records in the pilot.	

WHY RAZORPAY, AND WHY IT WINS

What Razorpay gains	**Razorpay has Ray and Optimizer on 15+ gateways.** Deal routing stays inside Razorpay, and working offers bring more EMI sales.
Why it wins	A leading orchestrator says 95%+ of its merchants route with hand-written rules. **I found no other tool that reads the deal, tests rules against it and confirms them live.**

3 KEY PRODUCT DECISIONS AND THE TRADE-OFFS BEHIND THEM

Decision	My choice	Why
Who acts?	The agent proposes and the merchant approves	Routing moves money, so trust comes before autonomy
Hero use case	Protect deals first and offer cost suggestions second	Lost deals are the clearest leak, and cost applies only to free routes
Test before apply	Every strategy runs through a what-if simulator first	Merchants see the effect before any money moves
When is it done?	Verified when the rule is live, reconciled when the ₹ arrives	Approved is not live, and live is not paid
Not building	Autonomous routing, AI in the payment path, negotiation	Trust, speed and privacy come first, and failover already exists

4 SUCCESS METRICS AND WHY I CHOSE THEM

Metric	What it measures	Pilot target	Why this metric
₹ protected per merchant ★	Reconciled deal benefits kept and fees saved over the old setup	Baseline set in pilot	It counts money received, not estimates
Coverage	Live deals verified or flagged for review	100%, 90%+ verified	No deal is left unchecked
Razorpay growth	Optimizer activations and offer checkout conversion	Baseline set in pilot	It shows growth for Razorpay, with no lift assumed
Speed and accuracy	Time to Verified, terms read correctly, unsafe writes	Under 15 min, 98%+, zero	It must beat manual work and earn trust

What I would test next. A shadow-mode pilot with a few multi-gateway merchants, where Ray checks live rules without changing them. I measure contract-reading accuracy, false alarms and estimated ₹ at risk against settlement records, then measure actual ₹ protected after controlled activation.

All names are fictional, and ₹ figures are estimates, not realised benefit. Sources Optimizer rules · Provider setup · Agent Studio · Orchestrators · UPI MDR